

SIGNAL & NOISE - Episode 12: The Generative Audio Boom

SCENE 1 - COLD OPEN

HOST: Welcome back to Signal and Noise. I am your host, and today we are talking about something genuinely exciting: generative audio and what it means for independent creators.

HOST: Five years ago, producing a serious documentary podcast meant a studio, an engineer, and a very calm week. Today it can mean an afternoon.

GUEST: Thanks for having me. I am excited to be here. I have spent the last three years building audio tooling, and the pace of change has been funny and a little terrifying at the same time.

SCENE 2 - THE MAIN CONVERSATION

HOST: Let us start with the basics. When people hear synthetic voice, they still picture something robotic and flat. Is that fair anymore?

GUEST: Not really. Modern speech models carry prosody, breath, and emphasis. The serious remaining challenge is direction: telling a model how a line should feel, not just what it says.

HOST: That sounds like the job of a director rather than an engineer.

GUEST: Exactly. The interesting work is now editorial. You are casting voices, setting pacing, choosing where the music swells. That is a calm, creative loop instead of a technical one.

HOST: What about music? Scoring has always been the expensive part for indie shows.

GUEST: Generative scoring changed the economics. You describe a mood, you get a bed that fits your runtime, and you can iterate in seconds rather than licensing something generic.

HOST: And the risk? People are nervous about authenticity.

GUEST: They should be thoughtful about it. Disclose synthetic voices. Never clone someone without consent. The tooling is neutral; the editorial standard is on us.

SCENE 3 - OUTRO

HOST: If a listener wants to produce their first episode this weekend, what is the one thing they should focus on?

GUEST: Structure. A happy, well-paced twenty minutes beats a sprawling hour every single time. The tools handle production; they do not handle judgment.

HOST: Perfect place to end. Thanks for joining us, and thanks to everyone listening. We will be back next week.